DEPCOM POWER // A KOCH ENGINEERED SOLUTIONS BUSINESS	Document #	Title	Revision	Released
	DPI-QA-FAI-0010	FAI Execution SOP	00	09/03/25

Originator	Approver
Gary Butzlaff III / Regional Quality Manager	Elijah Richardson / Senior Quality Manager

1. Purpose

1.1. The purpose of this SOP is to establish a standardized process for conducting First Article Inspections (FAI) to verify that installation processes consistently produce completed product that meet specified requirements. This SOP aims to ensure product quality, bolster customer confidence, and adhere to regulatory standards.

2. Scope

2.1. This SOP applies to all construction, quality assurance, and engineering personnel involved in the installation and inspection of new or significantly changed parts/products. The FAI process covers initial installation and subsequent verification when changes occur in design, location, or procedures.

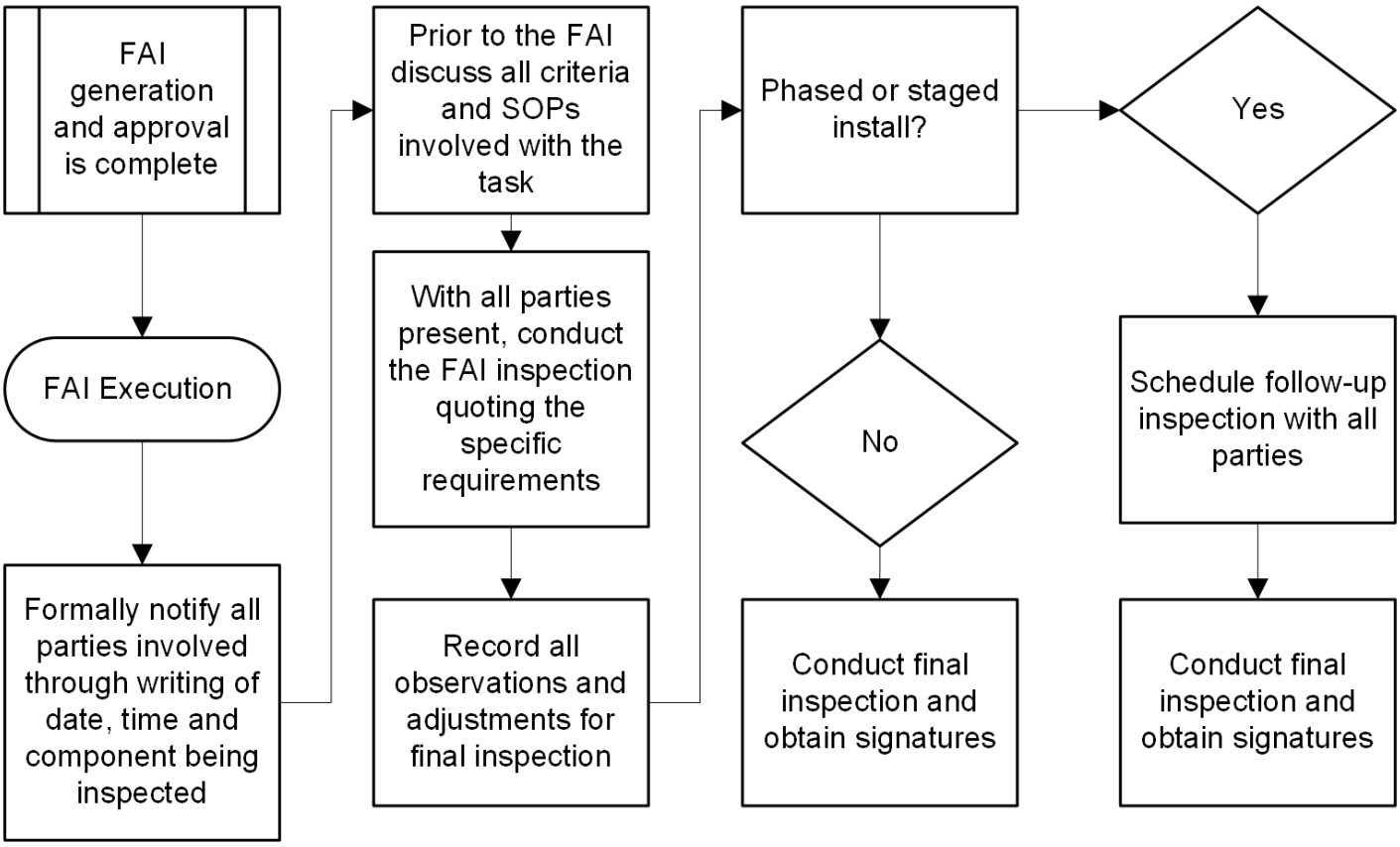
3. Reference Documents

3.1. Site Quality Manual
3.2. Site Inspection Plan
3.3. Quality FAI SOP, Templates and Training
3.4. Manufacturer Installation Manual
3.5. Manufacturer Site Specific Drawings
3.6. Applicable ACI, ACSI, ASTM, ISO, and NEC NFPA codes
3.7. Site Specific Approved Drawings
3.8. RFIs and Material Submittals

4. Responsibilities

ROLE	RESPONSILITIES
Regional Quality Manager	Review and approve FAI Checklists
Site Quality Manager	Cite quality requirements during inspection
Quality Control Technician	Understand the criteria of the inspection
Construction Manager	Attend and acknowledge
Superintendent SME	Lead installation process (Subcontractor SOP) allowing time for quality requirements
Field Engineer	Cite engineering requirements
Subcontractor	Provide SOPs for each task, provide insight into the installation process
Owner Representative	Attend and acknowledge and/or approve

5. Process Map



6. Procedure

6.1. Pre-construction meetings shall be conducted prior to field activities. First Article Inspections (FAIs) must be generated, reviewed, and formally approved prior to field implementation.

6.2. The Client, Construction Team, Subcontractor, and any other applicable stakeholders must be formally notified in writing of the scheduled date and time for the FAI. This notification must be issued in accordance with contractual and project-specific requirements.

6.2.1. In accordance with contractual requirements, the First Article Inspection (FAI) must be formally scheduled and communicated to all applicable parties—such as the Client, Construction Team, and Subcontractors—with sufficient advance notice as defined by the specific contract. The required lead time may vary by client but must be adhered to as stipulated. Adequate notice ensures proper coordination, resource allocation, and stakeholder availability. Failure to comply with the notification timeframe may result in project delays or rescheduling of the FAI.

6.3. On the morning of the scheduled FAI, representatives from the Client, Subcontractor, and DPI shall meet to review all inspection criteria and ensure alignment with the Subcontractor's Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs). This discussion may occur either within the Plan of the Day (PoD) meeting or in a dedicated session prior to the inspection.

6.4. The designated Superintendent Subject Matter Expert (SME) and the responsible Subcontractor shall lead the installation demonstration during the FAI, following the Subcontractor's approved SOP. As each component is presented, the corresponding Inspection Test Plan (ITP) and FAI line items shall be verbally referenced to confirm compliance with project specifications. The duration of the inspection shall be determined by the time necessary to fully evaluate all items and provide assurance to all participating parties. Any observations, deficiencies, or required adjustments must be documented for both recordkeeping and final inspection purposes.

6.4.1. For components installed in phases or stages, multiple FAIs may be required. This need must be identified and addressed during the Pre-Construction Meeting and reiterated in the preparatory discussion prior to the FAI. (I.E: Separate FAIs may be required for subgrade and aggregate installation at a Construction Entrance)

6.5. Later the same day, once the inspected task is reported as complete, all involved parties shall reconvene on-site for a final walkthrough. This follow-up inspection ensures all noted adjustments have been addressed. Verification, documentation, and formal approval of all modifications must be completed during this session.

6.5.1. If the FAI is not approved, the Quality Manager shall conduct a debrief with all stakeholders to review the identified discrepancies. The FAI must then be rescheduled. No further work on the scope of the failed inspection may proceed until the FAI is successfully completed and approved by all required parties.

6.6. All completed FAI documentation shall be archived in both the digital and physical project job books. PDF copies shall be uploaded to Viewpoint or the designated document management system for permanent project records.

7. Revision Table

REV. #	REV. DATE	DESCRIPTION	APPROVER
00	**09/03/25**	**Initial Release**	**Elijah Richardson**